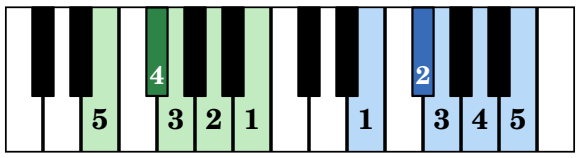
Unit 9

E Minor and D Minor

New: The relative minors of G major (E minor) and F major (D minor)

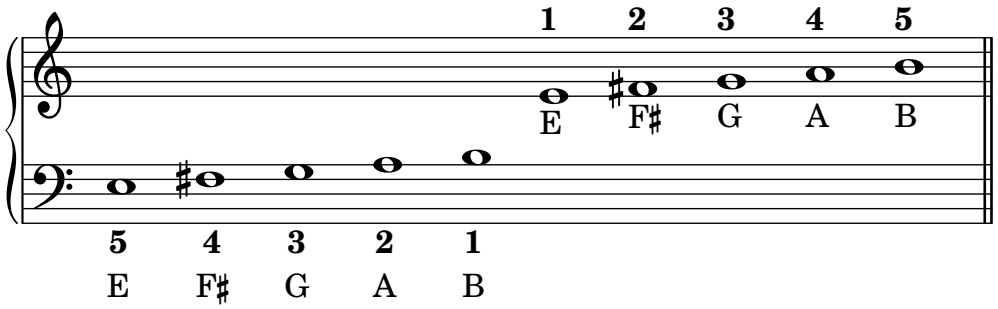
Two more minor keys. E minor is the relative minor of G major: the same key signature (one sharp, F-sharp), with home note E. D minor is the relative minor of F major: the same key signature (one flat, B-flat), with home note D.

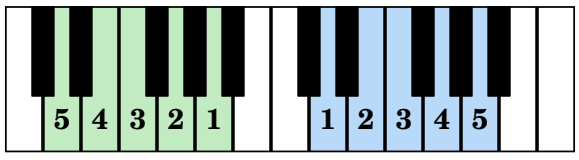


Middle C

Left hand E position and Right hand E position (green: left hand, blue: right hand)

Your notes

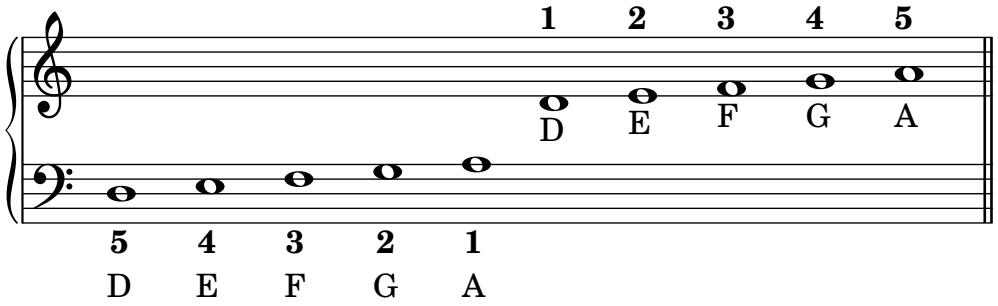




Middle C

Left hand D position and Right hand D position (green: left hand, blue: right hand)

Your notes



What is new

E minor

One sharp in the key signature, ending on E. In E position (E F-sharp G A B), the black key F-sharp is finger 2 in the right hand and finger 4 in the left.

D minor

One flat in the key signature, ending on D. D position (D E F G A) contains no B, so every note is a white key.

Which key?

One sharp: G major or E minor. One flat: F major or D minor. The last note and the lowest bass note tell you which.

Reading tips

1. Scan the key signature, then the last bass note, and name the key before you start.

2. In E position, put finger 2 (right hand) or finger 4 (left hand) on F-sharp first.

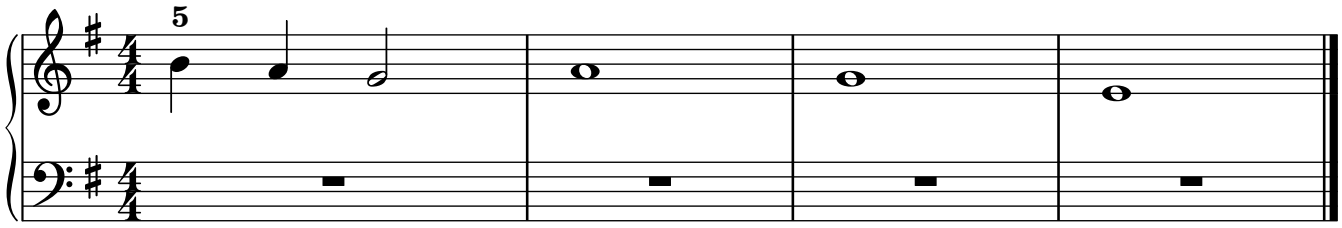
3. D minor's position uses only white keys, even though there is a flat in the key signature.

4. Keep going even if a note goes wrong.

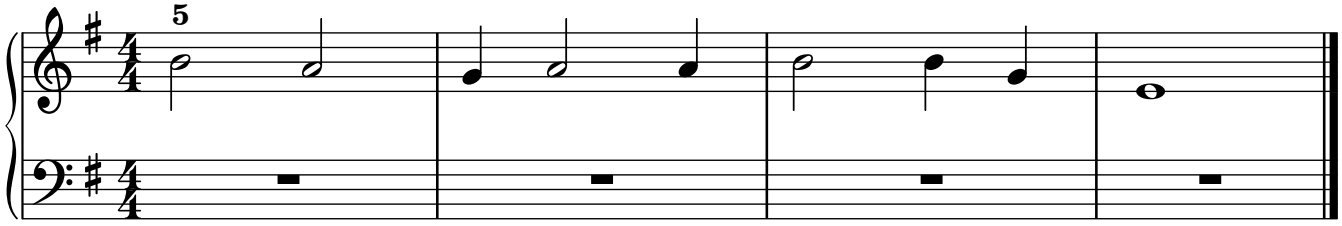
Part A: E minor, right hand ♩ = 60

E minor in the right hand. Metronome 60.

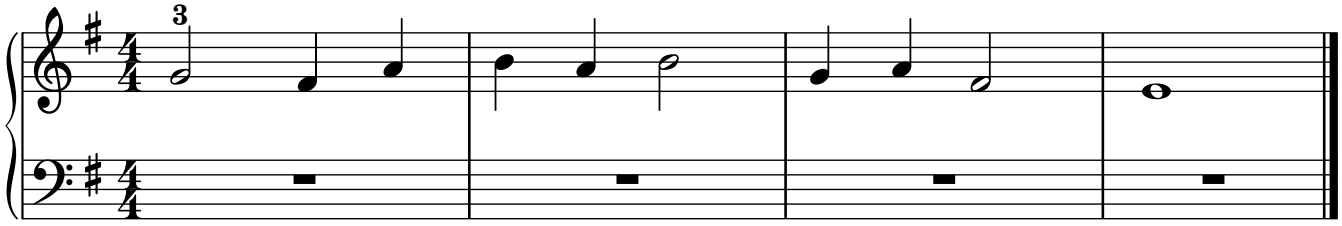
☐ **9.1**



☐ **9.2**



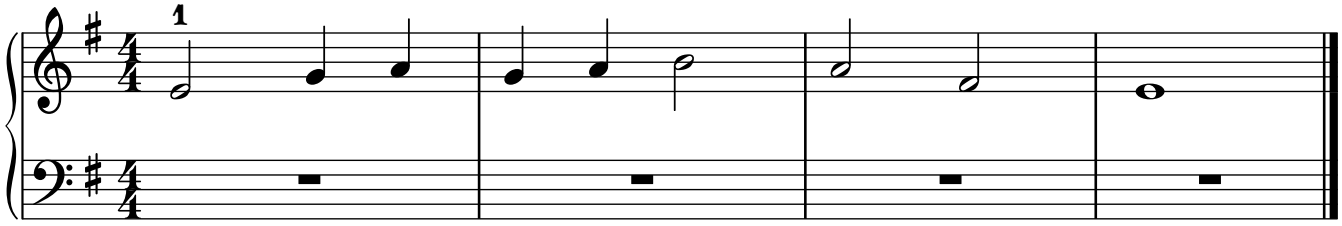
☐ **9.3**



☐ **9.4**



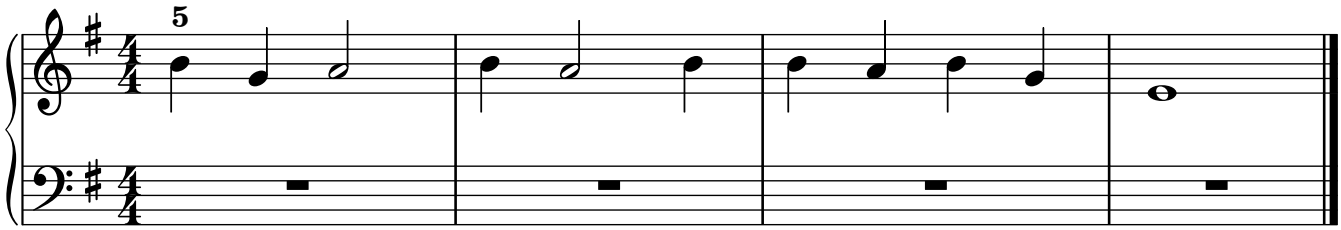
☐ **9.5**



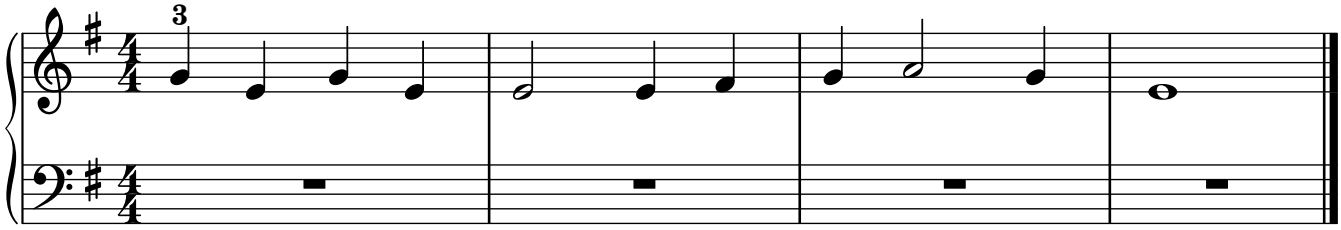
☐ **9.6**



☐ **9.7**



☐ **9.8**



Part B: E minor, hands together ♩ = 66

E minor, hands together.

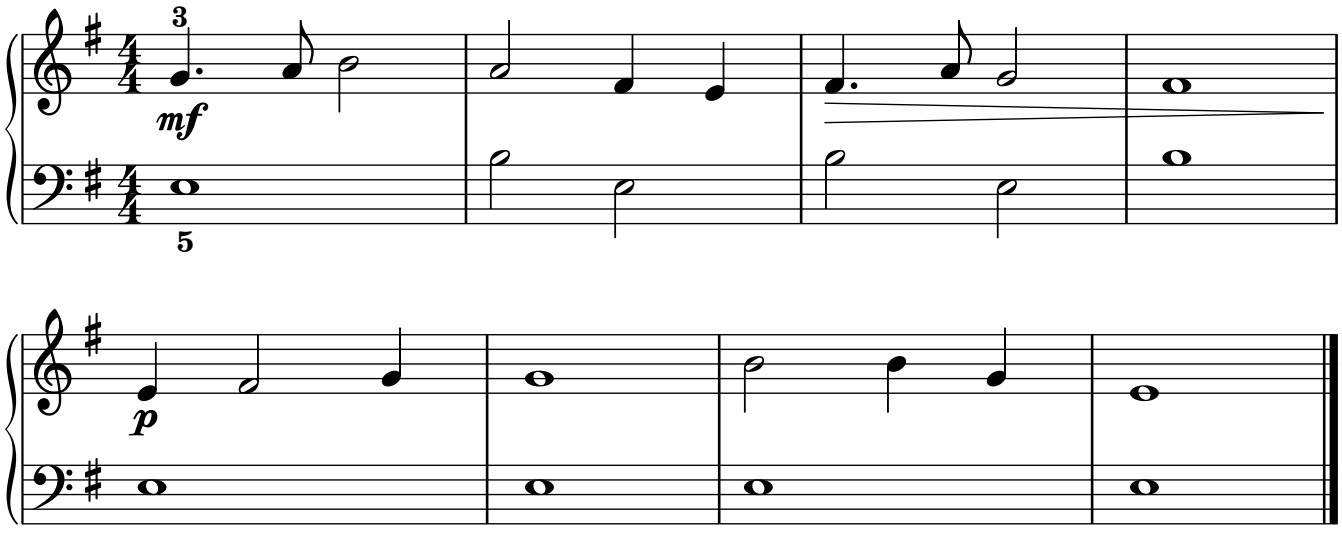
☐ **9.9**



☐ **9.10**



☐ **9.11**



9.12



9.13



9.14



9.15



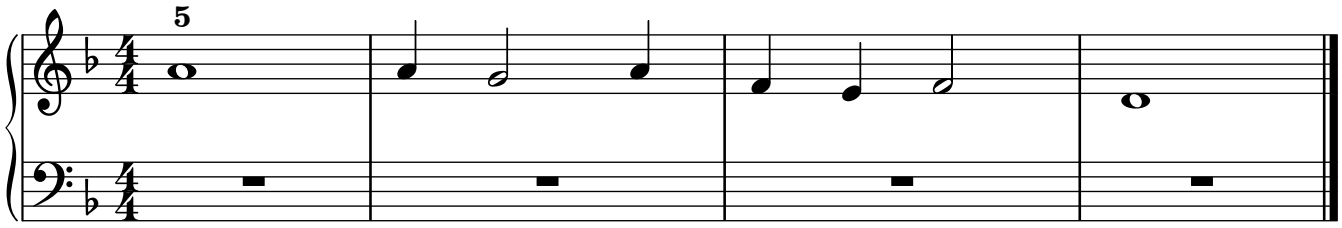
9.16



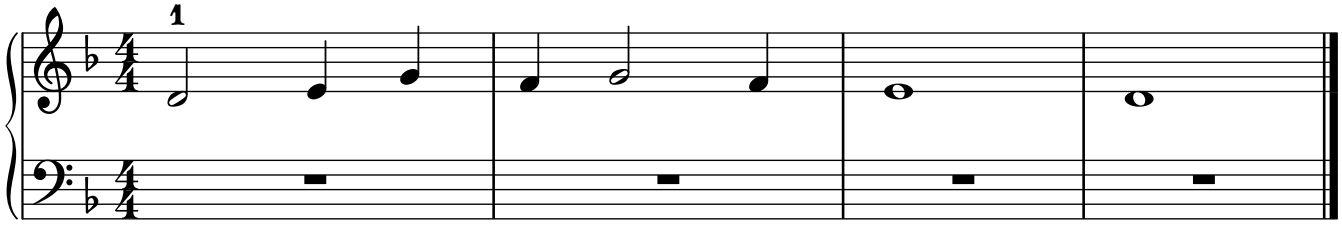
Part C: D minor, right hand ♩ = 60

D minor in the right hand.

☐ **9.17**



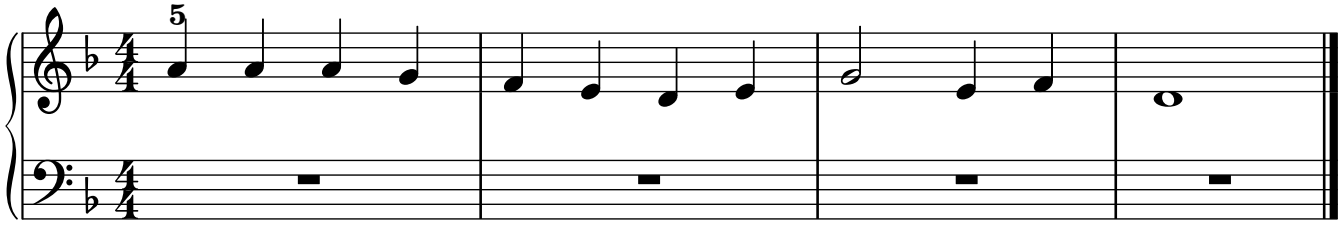
☐ **9.18**



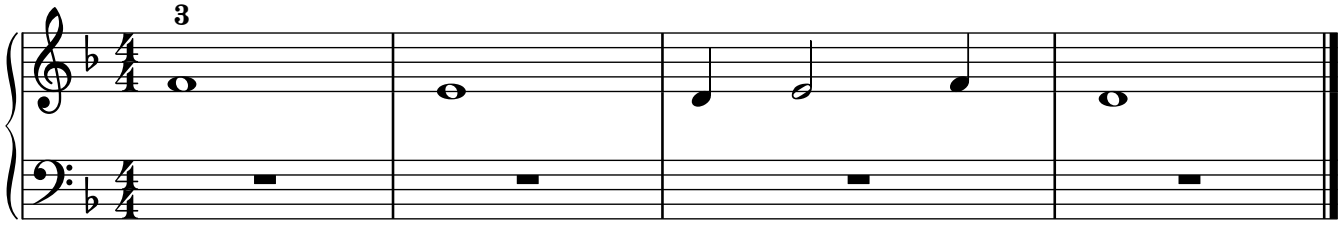
☐ **9.19**



☐ **9.20**



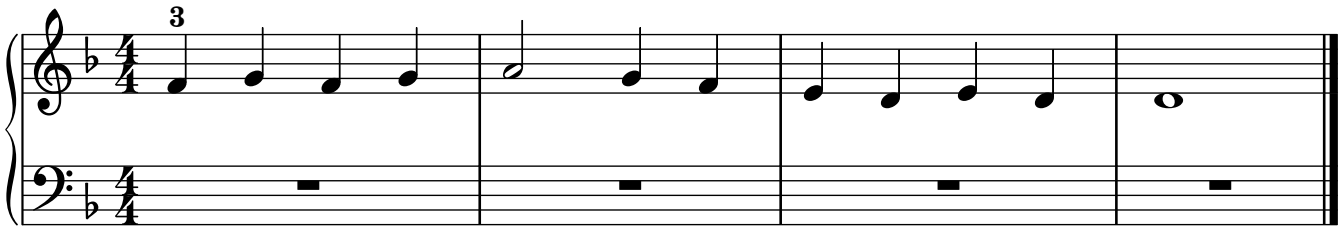
☐ **9.21**



☐ **9.22**



☐ **9.23**



☐ **9.24**



Part D: D minor, hands together ♩= 72

D minor, hands together in 3/4.

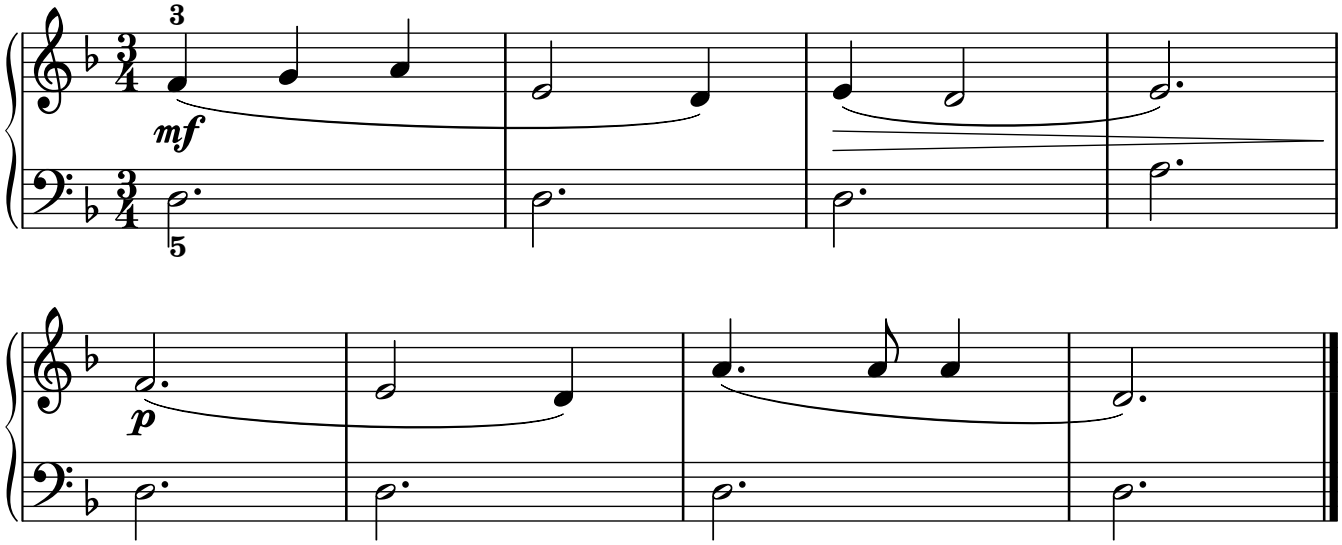
☐ **9.25**



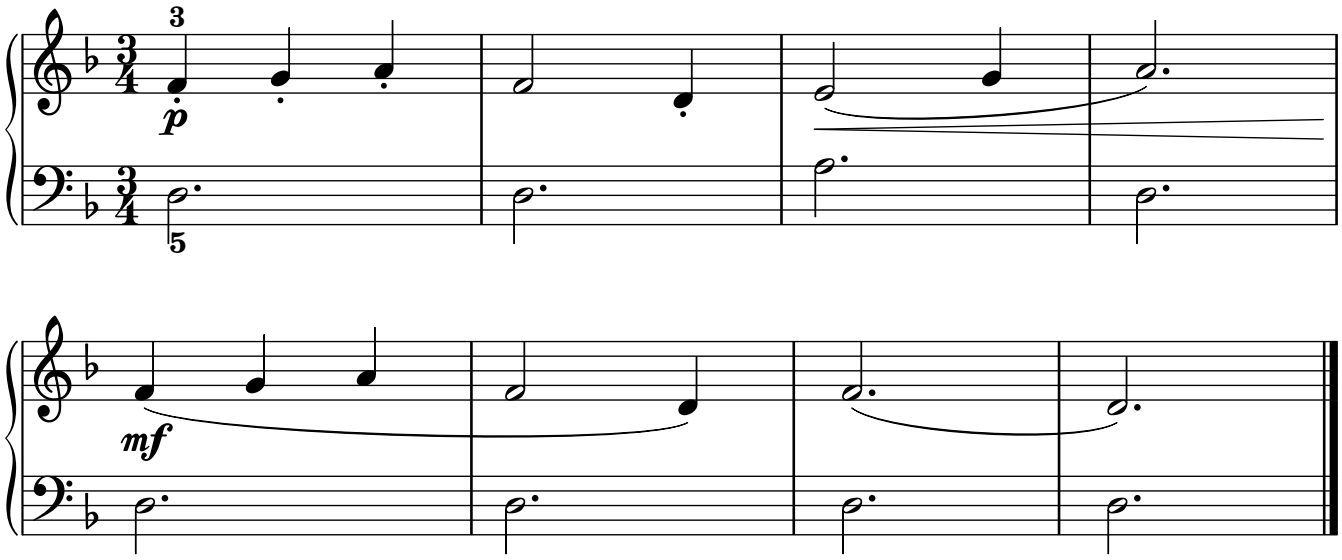
☐ **9.26**



☐ **9.27**



9.28



9.29



9.30



9.31



9.32



Pieces

Pieces are for playing more than once. Read each one first without stopping, like an exercise; then practise it until it sounds steady and musical.

Song in E Minor ♩ = 72

Original

The tune starts with the little finger on B. Finger 2 plays F-sharp; the bass alternates E (finger 5) and B (finger 1).



D Minor Waltz ♩ = 84

Original

D position, all white keys. The bass alternates D (finger 5) and A (finger 1).



E Minor Walk ♩ = 72

Original

For the left hand alone, in E position; finger 4 plays F-sharp.



Checkpoint: ready for Unit 10?

- Play three Part B and three Part D exercises you have not played before, at the speeds shown.
- Pass if you name each key correctly before you start.
- Pass if you play no more than one stop per exercise, and at least 9 notes out of 10 are right.
- When you pass, move on to Unit 10, the review.